Bang Bang Ji Si Chicken Salad

Salads | Sous vide

Before you start

Equipment: sous-vide bath, food-safe bag, ice bath, and grinder or mortar. Cook: 150°F for 1-4 hours; chill about 15 minutes. Garlic and scallions are divided.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Ingredients to grind; add reserved garlic

Bowl B - Dressing liquids and sesame paste

- [ ] 1 3/4 lb bone-in, skin-on split chicken breasts
- [ ] Salt and black pepper
- [ ] 6 garlic cloves, divided: 3 for the cooking bag; 3 for the dressing
- [ ] 6 scallions, divided: 2 roughly chopped for the bag; 4 thinly sliced for serving
- [ ] 1-inch piece fresh ginger, sliced
- [ ] 2 tsp toasted Sichuan peppercorns [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp sugar [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 tsp sesame seeds, plus more for garnish [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp sesame paste [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp soy sauce [Bowl B]
- [ ] 4 tsp Chinkiang or black vinegar [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/4 cup chile oil with sediment [Bowl B]

1. Cook and chill chicken

1. Season 1 3/4 lb bone-in, skin-on split chicken breasts with salt and black pepper.

2. Bag with 3 garlic cloves (half of the 6), 2 roughly chopped scallions (from the 6), and one sliced 1-inch piece ginger.

3. Sous vide at 150°F for 1-4 hours. Chill in an ice bath about 15 minutes.

2. Make dressing

1. Grind 2 tsp toasted Sichuan peppercorns, 1 Tbsp sugar, the remaining 3 garlic cloves, and 2 tsp sesame seeds into a rough paste.

2. Work in 1 Tbsp sesame paste, 1 Tbsp soy sauce, 4 tsp Chinkiang or black vinegar, and 1/4 cup chile oil with sediment.

3. Stir about 2 Tbsp chicken bag juices into the dressing.

3. Shred and toss

1. Remove chicken skin and bones and shred the meat. Thinly slice the remaining 4 scallions.
2. Toss the chicken with the dressing and sliced scallions. Adjust seasoning.
3. If desired, garnish with extra scallions, sesame seeds, and chile oil.